

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN MARTINIQUE

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Concern for the environment in Martinique turns above all on a poison in the soil — for this is a French Caribbean island, an overseas department of France and part of the European Union, whose defining environmental reality is the chlordécone catastrophe: a banana-plantation pesticide used for two decades after its dangers were known, which has contaminated the land for generations, tainted the rivers and the sea, restricted the fisheries, and left its trace in the blood of almost the entire population. That legacy — a persistent poison that will outlast everyone now living, the health harms it has caused, and the long, painful, and still-unfinished struggle for recognition, protection, and accountability — is the distinctive ground of environmental effort here, joined to the ongoing pressures of the banana and sugarcane monoculture that spread the poison, the sargassum tides that now foul the coasts, and the development that presses on a small island. This guide will treat the confronting of the chlordécone legacy, the protection of health and food, and the defence of the land and sea as the island's central environmental work, pursued through channels that are, distinctively, genuinely powerful — the French and European legal systems, the EU frameworks, the free press, and democratic protest — yet shadowed by a colonial history and an economic dependency that shape the whole struggle. Martinique is a mountainous volcanic island of banana fields and rainforest, of the towering Mount Pelée and the sea, a rule-of-law European territory with real courts and rights, but one where the poisoning of a people has met, so far, acknowledgment without full justice. This guide will be honest that the contamination is effectively permanent; that the criminal accountability has, after twenty years, been denied in the courts; that the banana monoculture endures and the economy depends on it; that the sargassum returns each year; and that a colonial and dependency dynamic runs through it all; but it will show that the levers here — the chlordécone struggle, the land and food, the sea and the sargassum, the coast and heritage, and the legal, EU, democratic, and community channels — are real, and, as the health recognitions and the powerful civic movement show, genuinely usable.

The Martinican story teaches two things about defending the environment here, and this guide states both plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever pressed together. The second is distinctly Martinican, and it is what gives this guide its particular force. **Because the chlordécone legacy can be confronted through health recognition, decontamination science, the legal and EU channels, and a powerful civic movement, because the land and food can be protected through agroecology and food-safety monitoring, because the sea and the sargassum can be managed, because the coast and heritage can be defended, and because the French and European legal, democratic, and community channels genuinely work, the levers run through the poisoned land and the law: the chlordécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels.** That combination — the chlordécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it, because in a rule-of-law European territory grappling with a permanent contamination and a colonial legacy, the strongest ground is the confronting of the chlordécone legacy and the defence of health, land, and sea through the law, the EU, and the movement.

But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide states plainly and takes seriously. **The contamination is permanent, the criminal accountability denied, the monoculture entrenched, the sargassum recurring, and a colonial dynamic runs through all.** The contamination will outlast

generations; the criminal case has been dismissed; the banana monoculture endures and the economy depends on it; the sargassum returns each year; and a colonial and dependency dynamic shapes the struggle. This guide does not pretend the poison can be removed, or that the courts have delivered criminal justice, or that the monoculture will vanish. What it shows is how, through the chlordécone struggle, the land and food, the sea and sargassum, the coast and heritage, and the channels, Martinicans — the communities, the affected families, the scientists, the civic movement, and their legal and EU allies — can confront the chlordécone legacy, protect health and food, and defend the land and sea, through the genuinely powerful channels this European territory affords, even as the poison endures.

Most people who care about Martinique's environment do not know HOW to use the levers a rule-of-law European territory with a permanent poison and a colonial legacy offers. They see the contaminated fields, the poisoned rivers, the restricted fishing grounds, the cancer that stalks families, the court case thrown out — and either despair of a poison that cannot be removed and a justice that has not come, or protest without the fuller set of levers that work: the health recognition and compensation, the decontamination science, the EU and human-rights channels, the food-safety protection, the powerful civic movement. The gap between the harm confronted and the harm endured is here often a gap of method — the method of using the chlordécone struggle, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels together.

This guide shows what can actually be tried — inside the Martinican reality as it is, which is a rule-of-law European territory confronting a permanent contamination and a colonial legacy through genuinely powerful legal, EU, democratic, and community channels. It is written for the person — in an affected community, among the island's scientists and health advocates, in its powerful civic movement, or among its legal and EU allies — who sees the poisoned land and the unfinished struggle and wants to know what can be done in a European territory where the channels work but the poison endures. The answer is a qualified yes: the levers are real — the chlordécone struggle, the land and food, the sea and sargassum, the coast and heritage, and the channels — with the honest qualifiers that the contamination is permanent, the criminal accountability denied, the monoculture entrenched, the sargassum recurring, and a colonial dynamic runs through all, so the work is legal, scientific, EU-oriented, democratic, community-based, and persistent. A note on who this guide is for, and on the spirit in which it should be used, because the Martinican case is particular and, for all its grief, comparatively hopeful in its channels. It is for the person — in an affected community, among the island's scientists and health advocates, in its powerful civic movement, or among its legal and EU allies — ready to do the rigorous, persistent, science-grounded work of confronting the chlordécone legacy and defending health, land, and sea through the courts, the EU, the health system, and mass mobilisation, rather than either despairing of a permanent poison and a denied justice or losing the strong factual ground in understandable anger. That is the right spirit here, because the levers that deliver — the health recognition, the food protection, the decontamination science, the legal and EU avenues, the movement — are genuinely available and genuinely effective in a rule-of-law society, and because the grievance, though profound and legitimate, is most powerful when grounded in the overwhelming and officially-acknowledged science. Anyone who approaches Martinique expecting the poison to be removed will be disappointed; anyone who approaches it through the law, the science, the health system, and the movement, persistently and grounded in the facts, can win real recognition, protection, and justice for a poisoned people. This guide is an honest map of that lawful, scientific, mobilised path.

The Strategic Framework

Effective efforts follow the same underlying pattern, adapted to a rule-of-law European territory with a permanent contamination:

STEP 1:	TARGET IDENTIFICATION	(find the harm, the exposure, and the framework)
STEP 2:	DOCUMENTATION	(build the evidence -- the harm and the science)
STEP 3:	LOCAL OPPOSITION	(build the community, scientific, and civic coalition)
STEP 4:	REGULATORY, CONTAMINATION & ENVIRONMENTAL JUSTICE	(chlordécone, land, sea)
STEP 5:	MEDIA STRATEGY	(make it a health-and-justice cause)

These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The evidence of the harm and the science feeds the chlordécone struggle, the food protection, and the sea defence at once; the community, scientific, and civic coalition organises; a health-recognition claim, a food-safety measure, or a legal action is both pressure and a spur to the next. The effort that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, gives itself the best chance of confronting the chlordécone legacy and defending health, land, and sea.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Martinique's — a rule-of-law European territory with a permanent contamination — give a distinctive set:

- **The chlordécone.** The **chlordécone legacy** can be confronted through health recognition, decontamination science, the legal and EU channels, and the civic movement — the distinctive lever.
- **The land.** The **land and food** can be protected through agroecology, food-safety monitoring, and pesticide regulation.
- **The sea.** The **sea, the fisheries, and the sargassum** can be managed through marine protection and monitoring.
- **The coast.** The **coast, the development, and the heritage** can be defended through the planning and conservation frameworks.
- **The channels.** The **French and European legal, EU, democratic, and community channels** genuinely work, though shadowed by a colonial dynamic.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers remove the poison, or that criminal justice has come, or that the monoculture will end. The contamination is **permanent**; the criminal accountability is **denied**; the monoculture is **entrenched**; the sargassum is **recurring**; and a colonial dynamic **runs through all**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them plainly, and it works through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement while reckoning with the colonial dynamic — and shows how to use the real tools this situation offers — the chlordécone struggle, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels — to confront the legacy and defend health, land, and sea, honestly acknowledging the permanent contamination, the denied accountability, the entrenched monoculture, the recurring sargassum, and the colonial dynamic.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see — and here, encouragingly, you must see that the levers run through genuinely powerful and accessible channels: the French and European legal systems, the EU environmental and human-rights frameworks, the health and food-safety institutions, the free press, democratic protest, and a strong and organised civic movement, because Martinique, whatever its colonial burdens, is a rule-of-law European territory with real courts, real rights, and real science. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides a matter's fate, at which level, and where the leverage is real. And map where the chlordécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels apply, because in Martinique a harm is met not

by confrontation with a closed state but through the law, the EU, the science, the health system, and the movement, reckoning honestly with the colonial and dependency dynamic that shadows them.

The Levels of Decision

A Martinican matter runs through a French and European rule-of-law system, with a distinctive colonial dimension.

The French state and its agencies. The **French state, its ministries, and its agencies — health, agriculture, environment, and food safety (such as ANSES and the health authorities)** hold the recognition, the monitoring, and the regulation, answerable to law and public pressure.

The local government. The **Collectivité Territoriale de Martinique and the local authorities** hold real devolved powers over the island's land, environment, and development.

The legal and EU frameworks. The **French courts, the European Union frameworks, and the European human-rights channels** offer genuine, powerful avenues, as the chlórdécone litigation and the EU complaint show.

The scientists and health institutions. The **researchers, doctors, and the decontamination and health scientists** hold the technical case on the poison, the health harms, and the remediation.

The civic movement and communities. The **powerful civic movement, the affected families and communities, and the free press** hold the moral force, the stake, and the public voice, as the mass mobilisations show.

The Journey of a Matter

A Martinican matter — the chlórdécone in the soil and blood, a contaminated food or fishery, the sargassum on the coast, a development pressing on the land — is met through the **chlórdécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels. The chlórdécone and the land are where the great questions are decided, and the sea, the coast, and the channels are what carry the effort** — and using them together, through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement, is the distinctive Martinican approach. The distinctive levers are the **chlórdécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels**. Find out exactly where the matter stands, and, crucially, **what harm, exposure, or resource is at stake, what French, EU, health, or food-safety framework applies, and how the law, the EU, the science, the health system, and the movement can be brought to bear**, because those are where a matter can genuinely be met.

Follow the Harm, the Exposure, and the Framework

Behind a matter stand the state, the agencies, the industry, and the land, health, food, and sea at stake — and, always here, the colonial and dependency dynamic. Trace who decides, who is exposed, what is harmed, and — importantly here — **what harm or exposure is at stake, what French, EU, health, or food-safety framework reaches it, what the science shows, and how the law, the EU, the science, the health system, and the movement can act**. Two questions unlock most Martinican efforts: **What is the harm, and what French, EU, or health framework reaches it?** and **Which lever — the chlórdécone, the land, the sea, the coast, the channels — can meet it?** The legal and EU channels, the health and food-safety system, the science, and the civic movement are, together, the heart of most such efforts here.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape a matter, because they are the levers. The **French state and agencies**; the **local government**; the **legal and EU frameworks**; the **scientists and health institutions**; and the **civic movement and communities**. In Martinique, the **chlordécone**, the **land**, the **sea**, the **coast**, and the **channels** are the most distinctive levers. Each is a separate front, and the poison in the soil, a contaminated food, the sargassum, or a threatening development can genuinely be met — through the law, the EU, the science, the health system, and the movement — and, because this is a rule-of-law European territory, those levers genuinely work, though the contamination is permanent, the accountability denied, and a colonial dynamic runs through all, and this guide will keep saying so.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit effort, calibrate honestly — and here the honest calibration is mixed: the channels are genuinely powerful, but the contamination is permanent and the criminal accountability has been denied. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how environmental and health efforts tend to go in rule-of-law European territories confronting a permanent contamination, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the harm can be **tied to the French or EU legal, health, or food-safety frameworks**, whether the **scientists, the civic movement, and the legal and EU allies** can be engaged, and whether the effort reckons with the **colonial and dependency dynamic**. Where the harm is documented and the legal, EU, health, and movement levers used, the levers here are real and often effective; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the contamination is permanent, the accountability denied, and the monoculture entrenched.

Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	20–30%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step
Chlordécone: health & recognition	35–55%	years	low–moderate	Health recognition, monitoring, compensation
Chlordécone: legal & EU accountability	20–40%	years	low–moderate	Accountability pressed; criminal route hard
Land / food safety & agroecology	35–55%	years	low–moderate	Food protected, land diversified
Sea / fisheries / sargassum	30–50%	years	low	Fisheries protected, sargassum managed
Coast / development / heritage	40–60%	months–years	low	The coast and heritage defended
Civic movement / democratic route	45–65%	months–years	low	The public mobilised, pressure sustained
All levers together	35–55%	years	moderate	Legacy confronted; health, land, sea defended

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and Martinique's real strength is its rule-of-law channels and its powerful movement: the **chlordécone**, the **land**, the **sea**, the **coast**, and the **channels**. Its constraints are specific and honest: the contamination is **permanent**, the criminal accountability **denied**, the monoculture **entrenched**, the sargassum **recurring**, and a colonial dynamic **runs through all** — but the legal, EU, health, and movement levers make the odds here genuinely real, especially on health recognition,

*A note on cost and risk: most levers here — a health-recognition claim, a food-safety demand, a legal action, an EU complaint, a democratic mobilisation — can be pursued openly and lawfully in a rule-of-law European territory, drawing on the courts, the EU, the science, the free press, and the movement. The scarce resources are **the legal and scientific capacity, the health and food-safety knowledge, and the civic organisation** — much of it reachable through the legal and EU channels, the health and research institutions, and the powerful civic movement. This shapes where a Martinican effort should concentrate its energy. Because the decisive resources are legal and scientific capacity, health and food-safety knowledge, and civic organisation — all of which a rule-of-law European territory with a powerful movement genuinely affords — an effort's most valuable investments are in marshalling the strong existing science, engaging the health-recognition and food-safety systems, pursuing the legal and EU avenues, and sustaining the mass mobilisation. A rigorous, well-organised, science-grounded effort that can marshal the overwhelming chlordécone research, press the health and food-safety systems, pursue the remaining legal and EU channels, and mobilise the practised movement can win real recognition, protection, and partial justice, even against a permanent harm. The resources that matter most are thus largely a matter of legal and scientific rigour, health and food-safety knowledge, and civic organisation — much of it reachable through the legal and EU channels, the health and research institutions, and the powerful civic movement. And because Martinique is a European territory with real rights, the law, the EU, and the movement are genuinely effective levers, even against a permanent harm.*

CHLORDÉCONE + LAND + SEA + COAST + CHANNELS:

Civic movement / democratic route:	■■■■■■■■■■■	45-65%
Coast / development / heritage:	■■■■■■■■■	40-60%
Chlordécone: health & recognition:	■■■■■■■	35-55%
Land / food safety & agroecology:	■■■■■■■	35-55%
Sea / fisheries / sargassum:	■■■■■■■	30-50%

PERMANENT CONTAMINATION / DENIED ACCOUNTABILITY / COLONIAL DYNAMIC -- harder ground:

Expecting the poison removed:	■■	impossible
Health, food, law & movement:	■■■■■■■■■	the real path
Legacy confronted, health defended:	■■■■■■■■■	genuinely achievable
The harm and science documented:	■■■■■■■■■	the reliable foundation

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The civic movement and the health recognition** — Martinique's distinctive levers; the mobilised public and the recognition of harm.
2. **The land and food safety and the agroecology** — the protection of what people eat and grow.

3. **The legal, EU, and human-rights accountability** — the pressing of responsibility, hard but real.
4. **The sea, the fisheries, and the coast** — the defence of the marine and coastal environment.
5. **The documented harm and science** — the evidence that grounds it all.

What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few honest patterns recur. **The channels are genuinely powerful** — real courts, real rights, real science, a real movement. **The health harm is now recognised in part** — the occupational-disease recognition a real, if partial, win. **The contamination is permanent** — to be managed, not removed. **The criminal accountability has been denied** — a bitter defeat, redirected to other avenues. **And a colonial dynamic runs through all** — to be reckoned with honestly. The through-line: **document the harm and the science; confront the chlordécone legacy through health recognition, decontamination science, the legal and EU channels, and the movement; protect the land and food through agroecology and food safety; defend the sea and manage the sargassum; protect the coast and heritage; use the law, the EU, the science, and the movement; and reckon with the colonial dynamic** — because an effort that does can genuinely confront the legacy and defend health, land, and sea, while being honest that the contamination is permanent, the criminal accountability denied, and the monoculture entrenched.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective effort begins by finding the exact harm and the leverage, which here runs through the French and EU legal, health, and food-safety frameworks, the science, and the civic movement. Vague concern goes nowhere; an effort aimed at "this harm or exposure, which the French or EU legal, health, or food-safety frameworks can reach, carried by the science, the movement, and the legal and EU allies" is a real, workable effort. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. **What is the harm?** This is the first question here. What **contamination, exposure, or resource harm** is at stake — the chlordécone in the soil, water, food, or blood; the health effects; the contaminated fishery; the sargassum; the threatened land or coast.
2. **What framework reaches it?** What **French or EU legal, health, food-safety, or environmental framework** reaches the harm — the health-recognition system, the food-safety rules, the environmental and pollution law, the EU and human-rights frameworks.
3. **Is it the chlordécone, the land, or the sea?** Whether the matter is one of the **chlordécone legacy**, the **land and food**, or the **sea and sargassum** — for each has its levers.
4. **What framework and dynamic apply?** What **legal, health, or regulatory framework** applies, and **how does the colonial and dependency dynamic** shape it, for the reckoning must be honest.
5. **How can the law, science, and movement act?** How the **courts, the EU, the scientists, the health system, and the civic movement** can act — openly, and reckoning with the colonial dynamic.

A Worked Example

Suppose an affected community finds its farmland and a nearby river contaminated with chlordécone, its families carrying the poison and fearing the cancer that stalks the island, and its locally grown root vegetables and river-caught fish unsafe — yet the people depend on that land and water and have had little

recognition or protection.

Working the five questions: **what is the harm? What framework reaches it? Is it the chlórdécone, the land, or the sea? What framework and dynamic apply?** And how can the law, science, and movement act? The driver is the chlórdécone contamination and exposure, with the health recognition, the food-safety monitoring, the decontamination science, and the legal and EU channels as the levers.

Within a season the effort has moved from "the land is poisoned and nothing can be done" to a real effort: document the contamination and the exposure; pursue the health recognition, monitoring, and compensation; secure food-safety testing and safe alternatives for what the community grows and eats; press the decontamination science and the legal and EU accountability; and mobilise the civic movement — all openly and lawfully, and reckoning with the colonial dynamic. That is a workable effort suited to Martinique — one that confronts the chlórdécone legacy and defends health and food through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement. Notice what the five questions accomplish, and how they suit a fight in a rule-of-law European territory confronting a permanent harm: they turn what might seem an unanswerable catastrophe — a poison that cannot be removed, a justice that has been denied, a colonial legacy that shadows all — into a set of specific, answerable questions, each attached to a lever that rests on the law, the health system, the science, and the movement, rather than on the removal of a poison that cannot be removed or the reversal of a court denial that stands. The harm becomes a documentable contamination, exposure, or health effect. The framework becomes the health-recognition, food-safety, environmental, legal, or EU one that reaches it. The category becomes the chlórdécone, the land, or the sea, each with its levers. The dynamic becomes the colonial and dependency reality to be reckoned with honestly. And the channels become the courts, the EU, the scientists, the health system, and the movement. That translation — from an unanswerable catastrophe into a set of specific, lawful, science-grounded actions — is the first and most important thing a Martinican effort does, because it moves the fight from despair at a permanent poison onto the firm ground of the law, the health system, and the movement, where, in a mobilised rule-of-law society, real recognition, protection, and partial justice can genuinely be won.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here a well-documented, scientific case has genuine legal, EU, health, and democratic channels to win through. A court, an agency, a health authority, the EU, the scientists, and the public all move on evidence — and in Martinique, a clear record of the harm and the science that establishes it is precisely what a rule-of-law effort turns into a real result, so build it well. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Harm, the Exposure, and the Framework

Get the facts the case turns on. Identify the **harm** — the contamination, the exposure, the health effect, the food or fishery risk — and, decisively here, **the framework that reaches it**: the health-recognition and monitoring system, the food-safety rules, the environmental and pollution law, the EU and human-rights frameworks. Establish exactly **what the harm is, who is exposed, and what framework reaches it**, because the harm-against-the-framework is the case's foundation.

Layer 2: The Harm, the Science, and the Health

Document the harm with the science. Establish the **environmental and health harm** — the soil, water, and marine contamination; the exposure in food, water, and blood; the health effects; the sargassum — drawing

on **the scientific studies, the health and epidemiological research, the food-safety and environmental monitoring, and the decontamination science**. This harm-and-science evidence, grounded in the strong existing research on chlordécone, turns the concern into a documented case the courts, the agencies, the EU, and the public can act on.

Layer 3: The Case, the Framework, the Channel, and the Dynamic

Finally, document the case and the path. Does the **harm** trigger a health recognition, breach a food-safety or environmental standard, or ground a legal or EU claim? What **framework** — health, food-safety, environmental, legal, EU — applies? Which **court, agency, EU body, or movement channel** will carry it, and **how does the colonial dynamic** shape it? Each is a separate element, and together they make a case the channels can act on, honestly. This is the layer that most often decides these efforts, because a documented harm, an applicable framework, a genuine channel, and an honest reckoning with the colonial dynamic are exactly what let a Martinican effort confront the legacy and defend health, land, and sea. Build it well, and the chlordécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels become the effort's genuine strength. One practical note on building this layer: because chlordécone is among the most thoroughly studied environmental contaminations in the world — investigated for decades by French and international health agencies, epidemiologists, toxicologists, soil scientists, and the state's own chlordécone plans — a great deal of the necessary evidence already exists and is genuinely obtainable, much of it official and public. The health-agency assessments, the blood-exposure studies, the epidemiological research linking chlordécone to prostate cancer and other harms, the soil and marine contamination maps, the food-safety monitoring, and the decontamination research are, in large part, matters of public and scientific record. This means an effort can often build a formidable case substantially from that existing official and scientific record, rather than gathering evidence from scratch, and can stand on ground the state's own agencies have already established. Building this layer well therefore means marshalling that rich existing record — the health data, the exposure studies, the contamination maps, the food-safety monitoring, the decontamination science — and joining it to the community's own knowledge of its land, water, and food, so that the case rests on the solid and officially-acknowledged foundation of one of the world's best-documented contaminations.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists — and here, in a rule-of-law European territory with strong science and real institutions, much of it is genuinely obtainable through public records, scientific studies, health data, and the well-documented chlordécone research. Here is where the material tends to live in a Martinican effort, and how to get it — with the **harm**, the **science**, the **framework**, and the **colonial dynamic** at the center. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

The Harm and Framework Record

Start with the harm and the framework. **The contamination and health data, the monitoring records, and the legal and regulatory documents** establish the harm; the distinctive strengths here are the **strong existing chlordécone research and monitoring** and the **French and EU legal, health, and food-safety frameworks**, all genuine and accessible. Establish the **harm, the exposure, and the framework that reaches it**, drawing on the contamination, health, and regulatory records. Establish exactly **what the harm is, who is exposed, and what framework reaches it**, because a harm tied to a real framework is strong ground.

The Harm, Science, and Health Evidence

This is the heart of the file. Gather the **harm evidence** — the soil, water, and marine contamination; the exposure in food, water, and blood; the health effects; the sargassum — and the **science** — drawing on **the scientific and epidemiological studies, the food-safety and environmental monitoring, the health data, and the decontamination research**. Chlordécone is among the most-studied contaminations in the world, so much of this evidence already exists; marshalling it is what turns the concern into a documented, actionable case.

The Framework, Legal, and EU Record

Document the levers of the frameworks. Gather the record of **the health-recognition and compensation system and the food-safety rules; the environmental and pollution law and the chlordécone plans; and the legal, EU, and human-rights channels and their precedents**. A community and its allies that understand the health recognition, the food-safety rules, and the legal and EU channels hold the levers that confront a contamination and defend health in a rule-of-law territory.

The Movement, Scientific, and Community Record

Document the wider levers. Gather the record of the **powerful civic movement, the affected families, and the community organisations; the scientists, doctors, and researchers; and the free press and the democratic and political channels**. A community joined to the movement, the scientists, and the press holds levers that reach from the affected field to the courts, the EU, and the public in a mobilised society.

The People, the Dynamic, and the Justice

Finally, map the human terrain, which in Martinique is inseparable from the colonial and dependency dynamic. Who is affected — the **farming and fishing communities, the exposed families, the workers, and the future generations** — and who can act: the **communities, the scientists, the movement, and the legal and EU allies**. And how does the effort **reckon honestly with the colonial and dependency dynamic and the demand for justice**? A Martinican effort is advanced through the chlordécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels — so map that coalition deliberately, engage the law and the movement, and let an honest reckoning with the colonial dynamic and the justice long sought govern every step.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here this step draws on a real strength, because Martinique has a powerful, organised, and experienced civic movement, a mobilised public, and the full apparatus of a rule-of-law society, so building the coalition means joining the affected communities to the movement, the scientists, and the legal and EU allies. The "opposition" that works here is a broad civic coalition pressing through the law, the science, the EU, and mass democratic mobilisation. The task is to build a coalition — of communities, movement, scientists, and legal allies — that confronts the chlordécone legacy and defends health, land, and sea.

Why the Community-Movement-Scientific-and-Legal Coalition Is Decisive

In Martinique, the coalition that works joins the affected communities to the powerful civic movement, the scientists, and the legal and EU allies, because a rule-of-law European territory responds to organised public pressure, sound science, and legal and EU action. That coalition supplies what a working effort runs on: the affected families and communities who hold the stake and the moral force, the powerful civic

movement that mobilises the public, the scientists whose evidence is strong and world-recognised, and the legal and EU allies who carry the cases and complaints. When the communities, the movement, the scientists, and the legal allies act together, they become a formidable force — as the mass mobilisations against chlordécone have shown. **A coalition that joins community, movement, science, and law here is not a marginal thing but a proven and powerful force in a mobilised, rule-of-law society — the real foundation of a Martinican effort, confronting the legacy and defending health, land, and sea.** This is worth dwelling on, because it marks what makes a Martinican effort distinctive in this series, and it is, in an important way, a source of hope amid a grievous harm. In many places in these guides, the obstacle is a closed or repressive state, and advocacy must be careful, indirect, or waged largely from outside; in Martinique, the obstacle is not repression but a permanent contamination, a denied accountability, and a colonial legacy, confronted within a rule-of-law European society that possesses real courts, real rights, strong and world-recognised science, a free press, EU and human-rights channels, and one of the most organised and experienced civic movements this series encounters. The chlordécone struggle has already mobilised tens of thousands, drawn a broad coalition of some thirty organisations across the overseas departments and the mainland, won the recognition of chlordécone-linked prostate cancer as an occupational disease, and carried the fight to the courts, the EU, and the human-rights bodies. The task, therefore, is to build and sustain that coalition of community, movement, science, and law, so that the affected families, the mobilised public, the rigorous scientists, and the legal and EU allies press together. This is not a marginal or hopeless thing but a proven and powerful force, for it confronts a grievous and permanent harm with the full apparatus of a rule-of-law society and a people who have shown they will not be silent.

Finding the Coalition

Begin with those the harm touches and those who can act — the **affected communities and families, the civic movement, the scientists, and the legal and EU allies** — for open, organised civic action is a real strength here. Widen to the wider public and the diaspora who share the cause. Name the shared stake — **our health, our land, our food, our sea, and the justice owed to a poisoned people** — because in Martinique the environmental harm and the demand for justice are one. Frame the effort around confronting the legacy and defending health, land, and sea, reckoning honestly with the colonial dynamic. There is real power in framing the cause this way, because it unites the environmental harm and the demand for justice, which in Martinique are inseparable, and because it draws on the full breadth of a mobilised society. A cause framed narrowly — as a technical pollution matter alone, or as a grievance detached from the science — would forfeit either the moral force or the factual high ground; a cause framed around health, land, sea, and justice together — the poison in the soil and the blood, the food and water to be protected, the sea and coast to be defended, and the recognition and accountability long owed — unites the affected families, the movement, the scientists, and the legal and EU allies, and speaks at once to the island, to mainland France, to Europe, and to the world. This framing is not only the more powerful one; it is also the truer one, because in Martinique the environmental harm genuinely is a matter of health and of justice, so uniting them is not a device but an accurate account of the island's real situation. An effort that names this frame precisely — health, land, sea, and justice, through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement — stands on the strongest and most honest ground the Martinican situation affords.

Coalition-Building, Through Community, Movement, Science, and Law

A coalition allied is stronger than any single actor, and in Martinique it is built through the community, the movement, the science, and the law. Reach to the **affected communities and families; the powerful civic movement and its organisations; the scientists, doctors, and researchers; the legal and EU allies; and**

the **free press and political representatives**. Frame the coalition around the chlordécone, the land, the sea, and the coast. Build breadth through the community, the movement, the science, and the law, reckoning with the colonial dynamic — for the coalition's strength is the union of community stake, mass mobilisation, scientific rigour, and legal and EU action in a mobilised, rule-of-law society.

Sustaining the Effort

Martinican efforts are sustained through the community, the movement, the science, and the law. Keep the coalition **informed, connected, and mobilised**; mark real steps — a health recognition won, a food-safety protection secured, a decontamination advance, a legal or EU claim advanced, a coast defended. And keep the effort grounded in the shared health, land, and justice that unite a poisoned people. The effort that lasts is the one that joins the community to the movement, the scientists, and the legal allies, presses through the law and the public, and reckons honestly with the colonial dynamic across the long struggle.

STEP 4: REGULATORY, CONTAMINATION & ENVIRONMENTAL-JUSTICE CHALLENGES — THE CHLORDÉCONE, THE LAND, AND THE SEA

This is where a Martinican effort is realistically and often effectively advanced — through the **confronting of the chlordécone legacy, the protection of the land and food, and the defence of the sea** — in a rule-of-law European territory, through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement, reckoning with the colonial dynamic. Here the chlordécone, land, and sea levers come together, because in Martinique a harm can be met through the health system, the food-safety rules, the courts, the EU, and the movement.

Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth, which here is mixed. The levers are **real and often effective, though the contamination is permanent and the criminal accountability denied**. The chlordécone health recognition is **real, a genuine if partial win**; the decontamination is **a matter of research and management, not removal**; the criminal accountability is **hard and, so far, denied, though other legal and EU avenues remain**; and the food and land protection is **achievable**. What these levers realistically achieve is **health recognition and compensation, food and water protection, decontamination research and management, a defended coast, and accountability pressed through the remaining avenues** — real outcomes in a rule-of-law territory, even against a permanent harm. Enter this front clear-eyed: the chlordécone, the land, and the sea are Martinique's distinctive levers, most effective when **grounded in the science and the law and carried by the movement** — though the contamination is permanent and the criminal justice denied.

The Chlordécone Legacy

The first front is the chlordécone. The **permanent contamination of the soil, water, and sea, the exposure of almost the whole population, and the health harms** can be confronted through the **health recognition and compensation — building on the recognition of chlordécone-linked prostate cancer as an occupational disease — the health monitoring and screening, the decontamination science and management, the food-safety protection, and the legal, EU, and human-rights accountability**, pressed through the courts, the EU, and the movement, even as the criminal route has, after twenty years, been denied. Use the chlordécone legacy, because though the poison cannot be removed and criminal justice has so far been refused, the health recognition, the compensation, the monitoring, the

decontamination research, the food protection, and the remaining legal and EU avenues are real and can still deliver genuine protection, recognition, and accountability to a poisoned people. It is worth being clear about both the power and the limits of this chlordécone front, honestly, for it is the defining lever a Martinican effort holds. Its power lies in a rare combination: a grievous harm that is overwhelmingly documented and officially acknowledged, a population overwhelmingly affected, strong and world-recognised science, real courts and rights, EU and human-rights channels, and a powerful, practised movement — so that the pressure for recognition, protection, and accountability rests on ground few environmental struggles can match. Its limits are equally real and must be stated plainly: the contamination is permanent and cannot be removed, only managed and researched; the criminal accountability has, after twenty years, been denied by the courts; and the colonial and dependency dynamic that let the harm arise still shapes how slowly it is answered. Understanding both means using the chlordécone front for what it can genuinely deliver — health recognition and compensation, monitoring and screening, food protection, decontamination research, and accountability through the remaining legal and EU avenues — while being honest that the poison endures and the criminal justice has been refused, so the struggle is long, and its victories are measured in recognition, protection, and partial justice rather than in the removal of a harm that cannot be removed.

The Land and the Food

The second front is the land and the food. The **contaminated agricultural land, the banana and sugarcane monoculture that spread the poison and endures, and the safety of what people grow and eat** can be protected through **food-safety monitoring and testing, the guidance on what can safely be grown where, the shift toward agroecology and diversification away from the chemical monoculture, the pesticide regulation, and support for affected farmers**, reckoning with the economic dependence on bananas and the land and industry concentration. Use the land and the food, because protecting what people eat and grow — testing the crops and water, guiding safe cultivation, and shifting toward a diversified, agroecological farming less dependent on the chemical monoculture — is the daily defence of health on a contaminated island, pursued with regard for the livelihoods bound to the land.

The Sea, the Fisheries, and the Sargassum

The third front is the sea. The **marine contamination and the fishing restrictions it forces, the coastal and reef environment, and the sargassum tides that foul the coasts and threaten health, fishing, and tourism** can be defended through **the fisheries protection and monitoring, the marine and reef conservation, and the management of the sargassum — its collection, its use, and the protection of the communities from its fumes**. Press the sea, the fisheries, and the sargassum, because the marine contamination and the sargassum are, with the chlordécone, the daily environmental burdens of the coast, and protecting the fisheries, the reefs, and the coastal communities defends both the livelihoods and the health bound to the sea. Pursued together — the chlordécone, the land, and the sea — these fronts are how a Martinican effort confronts the legacy and defends health, land, and sea, through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement, reckoning with the colonial dynamic. It is worth understanding why these fronts reinforce one another so well in Martinique's particular situation, for they are bound together by the same poison and the same struggle. The chlordécone front confronts the contamination and its health harms head-on, through recognition, science, and the law. The land-and-food front protects what people grow and eat on contaminated ground, translating the abstract harm into daily safety. And the sea front defends the fisheries and the coast, where the poison and the sargassum meet. Each covers the others' reach: the chlordécone at the level of the health and the accountability, the land at the level of the food and the farming, and the sea at the level of the fisheries and the coast. And each strengthens the others, for the science that documents the poison in the soil documents it in the food and the fish, the health recognition that names the

harm supports the food protection and the fisheries case, and the movement that mobilises for justice mobilises for safe food and a defended sea alike. An effort that grasps this mutual reinforcement, and pursues each front together through the law, the science, and the movement, makes the fullest use of the several legal, health, food-safety, and marine levers that a rule-of-law European territory provides, uniting them in a single struggle for health and justice.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same file of harm and science becomes different arguments for the French state, the local government, the courts and EU, the scientists, and the public. Translate deliberately, and always reckoning with the colonial dynamic and the justice sought.

For the French State and Its Agencies

The French state and its agencies respond to **the law, the health obligation, and the public and political pressure**. Frame the harm as a matter of the state's responsibility and obligation: here is the exposure, the health harm, the recognition and protection owed, the framework that requires it. Give them the documented harm and the science, and press for the recognition, the monitoring, the compensation, and the remediation. Make it concrete: *here is the population exposed, here is the health recognition, screening, and protection the state must provide*. This is the argument a state that has acknowledged its share of responsibility must answer.

For the Local Government

The local government responds to **the island's health, land, and future**. Frame the harm as a matter of the island's own environment and people: here is the contaminated land, the food safety, the coast, the powers you hold. Give them the case, and press for the local action on food safety, land, agroecology, and the coast. The Collectivité and the local authorities hold real devolved powers to act.

For the Courts, the EU, and the Human-Rights Bodies

The courts, the EU, and the human-rights bodies respond to **the law, the rights, and the frameworks**. Frame the harm as a legal and rights matter: here is the exposure, the harm, the responsibility, the framework or right engaged. Give them the documented case, and pursue the legal, EU, and human-rights avenues, even where the criminal route has been denied. The EU and human-rights channels remain genuine avenues.

For the Scientists, Movement, and Public

The scientists, movement, and public respond to **the health, the justice, and the science**. Translate the file into the story of a poisoned people seeking protection and justice: here is the exposure, the harm, the science, the recognition and defence owed. Frame it as the health and justice of a people. Keep it accurate and grounded in the strong science. And the scientists, the movement, and the public, engaged, are a formidable force in a mobilised society.

The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate, ground everything in the strong science, and reckon honestly with the colonial dynamic. Your credibility rests on the real harm and the real science — the health, legal, EU, and scientific case, honest about the permanence of the poison and the denied accountability. State the harm

precisely, tie it to the chlordécone, the land, or the sea, and press through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement. An effort that is precise, scientific, and just is far more powerful in a rule-of-law European territory than one that overreaches or loses the strong factual ground.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and attention convert your evidence into pressure — and here, with a free press, a mobilised public, a powerful movement, and an international audience for one of the world's starkest environmental-justice scandals, media is a genuine and powerful lever. The story — a people poisoned by a pesticide used for decades after its dangers were known, seeking protection and justice — resonates at home, in mainland France, in Europe, and worldwide.

Why Media Matters

The state, the courts, the EU, and the public behave differently when the harm and the science are visible. Media does three things here: it **informs and mobilises the public and the movement**, it **raises the stakes** for a state and institutions mindful of a recognised scandal, and it **reaches the mainland French, European, and international audiences**. The free press, the mobilised public, and the international interest make media a genuine channel. The story is already one of the world's most documented environmental-justice cases, so the media effort builds on strong, established ground.

Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the health and the justice. The strongest frame is stark and true: *a people poisoned — the pesticide used for two decades after its dangers were known, the soil contaminated for generations, the poison in the blood of nearly everyone, the cancer that stalks families — seeking the protection, the recognition, and the justice long owed*. Put the health harm and the demand for justice first, because the story of a mass poisoning and an unfinished search for justice is powerful and internationally resonant. Keep it scrupulously accurate and grounded in the science; and present the colonial and environmental-justice dimension factually, as the documented reality and the movement's own framing. The Martinican story is powerful because the harm is grave and documented, the science strong, and the justice long sought.

Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience. **The Martinican press and the civic movement's networks** for the island; **the mainland French and European media** for the wider public; **the international environmental and human-rights media** for the world; and **the scientific and legal channels** for the evidence. Because the press is free and the story internationally resonant, all these channels are open — the health harm, the science, and the justice sought are the story's power.

A Few Cautions

Stay accurate, scientific, and grounded — the aim is the confronting of the legacy and the defence of health, land, and sea, framed around the chlordécone, the land, and the sea. Present the colonial and environmental-justice dimension factually and as the documented reality and the movement's framing, and handle the broader political questions — the relationship with France, the questions of autonomy or independence — factually and evenhandedly, keeping the focus on the environment, the health, and the justice. And sustain the story across the long struggle. Above all, let the documented harm, the strong science, and the justice long sought carry the story, because that is where a Martinican effort is strongest.

EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real harm, the real science, keep it factual and grounded, and reckon with the colonial dynamic. Here the law, the EU, the health system, and the movement win.

8A: Requesting Information

Subject: Request for information — contamination and health data for [area]

To [agency / authority],

I am writing on behalf of [community / group] regarding the chlordécone contamination and its effects in [area]. Under the applicable access and environmental-information provisions, I respectfully request the **contamination and monitoring data**, the **health and food-safety assessments**, and the **relevant records** for the area.

I would be grateful for a response within the legal time limit.

Respectfully,

[Name, community / group, contact]

8B: The Chlordécone Health & Recognition Case

Subject: Health recognition, monitoring, and protection for the exposed in [area]

To [health authority / state agency],

The population of [area] has been exposed to chlordécone, with the health harms the science now recognises. Building on the recognition of chlordécone-linked prostate cancer as an occupational disease, we respectfully urge health monitoring and screening, recognition and compensation for the affected, and protection. We attach the evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8C: The Land / Food-Safety Case

Subject: Food safety and safe cultivation on contaminated land in [area]

To [food-safety / agriculture authority],

The land in [area] is contaminated, and the safety of local food and water is at risk. We respectfully urge food-safety testing, guidance on safe cultivation, support for agroecological diversification, and protection for affected farmers. We attach the data.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8D: The Sea / Fisheries / Sargassum Case

Subject: Protecting the fisheries and managing the sargassum at [location]

To [marine / environment authority],

The marine contamination and the sargassum at [location] threaten the fisheries, the coast, and health. We respectfully urge fisheries protection and monitoring, marine conservation, and the management of the sargassum and protection from its fumes. We attach the evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8E: The Legal / EU Accountability Case

Subject: Pursuing accountability and rights on chlordécone

To [legal counsel / EU or human-rights body],

Regarding the chlordécone contamination and its harms, and the denial of the criminal case, we respectfully seek to pursue the remaining legal, EU, and human-rights avenues for accountability and the protection of rights. We attach the documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8F: To a Scientific or Research Body

Subject: The science of chlordécone contamination and decontamination in [area]

Dear [research institution],

We write regarding the chlordécone contamination in [area] and respectfully seek your scientific engagement — the studies, the monitoring, and the decontamination research — on the harm and its management. We provide the documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name, group, contact]

8G: Media / Documentation Pitch

Subject: A people poisoned, seeking justice — the chlordécone story in [area]

Dear [journalist / editor],

In Martinique, a pesticide used for two decades after its dangers were known has contaminated the land for generations and left its trace in nearly everyone's blood, and the people are seeking the protection, recognition, and justice long owed. There is a powerful, documented, resonant story here, and we can provide the science, the health data, and the community's voices.

Sincerely,

[Name, contact]

8H: Rallying the Community

Subject: Our health, our land, our justice — let us stand together

Dear neighbours,

Our land and water carry the chlordécone, our families carry it in their blood, and the justice we have sought has been long delayed. But we are a people with a strong voice, real rights, and a proven movement, and together — through the courts, the science, the EU, and our own mobilisation — we can win recognition, protection, and justice. Please join us: share what you know, and add your voice.

With respect,

[Name, community]

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes a matter is acute — a contaminated food reaching the market, a health-recognition deadline, a legal or EU window, a sargassum influx, a development advancing — and you cannot run the full effort. Triage to the levers that work fastest here, which means the documentation and the science, the health and food-safety channels, and the civic movement.

The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what is the harm, and what framework reaches it**. Identify the immediate matter — a **contaminated food, a health deadline, a legal or EU window, a sargassum influx, a development** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **community, the movement, the scientists, and the relevant authority or legal ally** at once, because in Martinique the documentation, the health and food-safety channels, and the civic movement are the fastest routes to real leverage.

The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **The food-safety channel** can act fast on a contaminated food. **The health-recognition claim** can be filed within its windows. **The civic movement** can mobilise quickly in a practised, organised society. **The free press** can raise a matter fast. **The legal or EU filing** can meet a deadline. These outpace the slower work of the decontamination and the deep accountability — which continue alongside — because the food-safety, health, movement, and legal channels can be brought to bear immediately. Above all, if a contaminated food or an exposure is reaching people, act through the food-safety and health channels fast, because protecting people from exposure is the most urgent good.

Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a full coalition overnight, but here you can mobilise the community, the movement, the scientists, and the legal allies fast. Reach immediately to the **community, the movement, the scientists, and the legal and EU allies**. A coalition documenting the harm, acting through the health and food-safety channels, and mobilising the movement is the most a rapid Martinican effort can do — and in a mobilised, rule-of-law society, it can be effective. Speed favours the prepared: know the harm, the framework, and the channels before the matter breaks.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here, honestly, the field is tilted not by repression — Martinique is a rule-of-law European territory with real courts and rights — but by the permanence of a contamination that cannot be removed, by the denial after twenty years of the criminal accountability, by an economic dependence on the banana monoculture, by a striking concentration of land and agri-food power, and above all by a colonial and dependency dynamic in which a pesticide banned elsewhere was allowed to be used here for years longer. Name it plainly, because

pretending the poison can be removed, or that criminal justice has come, or that the colonial dynamic does not shape it all, would each be false — but the rule of law, the EU and human-rights channels, the strong science, and the powerful movement make even this tilted field one where real recognition, protection, and partial justice can be won.

Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific and honest. **The contamination is permanent** — the poison cannot be removed. **The criminal accountability has been denied** — after twenty years, the case dismissed. **The economy depends on the monoculture** — the bananas endure. **The land and agri-food power is concentrated** — a small group holds much. And **a colonial and dependency dynamic runs through all** — a pesticide banned elsewhere used here for years longer. But **the rule of law, the EU and human-rights channels, the strong science, and the powerful movement** are real, effective levers. This is a tilt of permanence, denial, dependence, and colonial dynamic, worked through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement.

Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field is tilted this way, use the levers of law, science, and mobilisation. Lean on the **rule of law and the remaining legal, EU, and human-rights avenues**, which persist even after the criminal denial; the **strong, world-recognised science**, which no one can gainsay; the **health-recognition and food-safety systems**, which deliver real protection; the **powerful, practised civic movement**, which mobilises the public; and the **free press and the international attention**, which a documented scandal commands. Meet the permanence and the denial not with despair but with the pursuit of every remaining avenue — health recognition, compensation, food protection, decontamination research, EU and human-rights action, and mass mobilisation. And build the coalition over time, because in a mobilised, rule-of-law society these accumulate into real recognition, protection, and partial justice. A field tilted by permanence and colonial dynamic is worked through the law, the science, the health system, and the movement, persistently.

The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may not win all you seek — the poison will remain, the criminal justice may stay denied, the monoculture may endure — and this guide will not pretend otherwise; the contamination is permanent and the accountability, so far, refused. But here, in a rule-of-law European territory, the work is rarely wasted and real gains are genuinely won: the **harm was documented, the health recognised, the food protected, the science advanced, the accountability pressed, and the movement sustained** — and in a mobilised society, a rigorous, persistent, science-grounded effort has already won health recognition, compensation, and acknowledgment, and can win more. Press on through the law, the science, the EU, and the movement; the confronting of a permanent harm is a long struggle, but each health recognition, each food protection, each decontamination advance, each measure of accountability and justice is a real and lasting good for a poisoned people.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — OR STRUCTURAL POWER AND NEGLECT

In Martinique, the honest picture is less one of ordinary bribery than of structural power and neglect, because a striking concentration of land and agri-food power, and a colonial and dependency dynamic in which a pesticide banned in mainland France and elsewhere was permitted here for years longer, together shape how the harm arose and how slowly it has been answered — and because the interests bound up with the monoculture have long weight in a small, dependent economy. The concern here is the structural

power of the few over the land and the industry, and the neglect of a distant people, more than simple corruption. The response runs through the law, the EU, the transparency, and the movement.

Telling Structural Power from Ordinary Corruption

Here the concern is structural power and neglect, and its marks are specific: **the concentration of land and agri-food power in few hands, the derogation that let a banned pesticide be used here for years longer, the slowness and denial of accountability, and the sense of a distant people treated as expendable.** The task is to document it factually and press it through the transparency, the law, the EU, and the movement, relying on the public records, the documented history, the scientific record, and the free press. And note that Martinique's rule of law, EU and human-rights channels, and powerful movement give real, legitimate tools to confront structural power and demand recognition, transparency, and justice.

Responding to Structural Power — Through Law, Transparency, and the Movement

Where the structural power and neglect are real, the response runs through the legitimate channels. Use the **transparency and the documented history** to establish how the harm arose and was answered. Use the **rule of law and the remaining legal, EU, and human-rights avenues** to press responsibility. Use the **strong science** to establish the harm beyond dispute. And use the **powerful civic movement and the free press** to demand recognition and justice. Document rigorously, present the colonial and environmental-justice dimension factually and as the documented reality and the movement's framing, and keep to the legitimate channels, because in a rule-of-law territory these are both the right and the effective tools. Route the effort through the law, the EU, the transparency, and the movement — persistently, and grounded always in the strong, documented facts.

A Note on Openness and Care

This note is, encouragingly, mostly a reassuring one, because Martinique is a rule-of-law European territory where people can research, publish, organise, litigate, and protest freely, and where the courts, the EU, the free press, and the movement are real and strong. The work here can be done openly and vigorously. Exercise ordinary care — document rigorously, ground everything in the strong science, keep the factual high ground, and build the broadest coalition — but do not mistake this for a place where advocacy must be hidden: it is a mobilised, rule-of-law society with a proven movement. Present the colonial and environmental-justice dimension factually and as the documented reality and the movement's own framing, and handle the broader political questions — the relationship with France, the questions of autonomy or independence — factually and evenhandedly, keeping the focus on the environment, the health, and the justice. The openness, the science, the law, and the movement are the assets here: use them fully, rigorously, and persistently.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others — all through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement, reckoning with the colonial dynamic. Here is how they fit into a single Martinican effort.

The Parallel Effort

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the harm-and-science file. **Target identification** aims it at the levers. **Local opposition**, understood as the community-movement-scientific-and-legal coalition, organises the communities, the movement, the scientists, and the legal allies. **Regulatory, contamination, and environmental-justice** work confronts the chlórdécone, protects the land and food, and defends the sea. **Media**, powerful and grounded, carries the health-and-justice cause. The harm-and-science feeds all five at once — a documented case is a health claim, a food-safety demand, a legal or EU action, and a mass mobilisation together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall — and here, through the law and the movement, they compound into real recognition, protection, and partial justice.

A Rough Timeline

Early (weeks 1–8): establish the harm and the science; identify the chlórdécone, the land, the sea, and the coast; build the community-movement-scientific-and-legal coalition and begin documentation. **Middle (months–years):** confront the chlórdécone through health recognition, food protection, decontamination research, and legal and EU action; protect the land and food; and defend the sea and manage the sargassum. **Later (years):** see health recognised, food protected, decontamination advanced, the coast defended, and accountability pressed — real, if partial, outcomes in a rule-of-law territory. A Martinican effort works through the law, the science, and the movement across a long struggle; pace it accordingly, and reckon always with the colonial dynamic.

The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that gives these efforts their force: **document the harm and the science; confront the chlórdécone legacy through health recognition, decontamination science, the legal and EU channels, and the movement; protect the land and food through agroecology and food safety; defend the sea and manage the sargassum; protect the coast and heritage; use the law, the EU, the science, and the movement; and reckon with the colonial dynamic.** The coalition that presses all five, through the law and the movement and honestly, is the one that can genuinely confront the legacy and defend health, land, and sea — the kind of real result a rule-of-law European territory allows, even against a permanent harm.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Confronting the environmental legacy in Martinique is genuinely achievable in real and important measure, because Martinique is a rule-of-law European territory with strong science, real courts and rights, EU and human-rights channels, a free press, and a powerful, practised civic movement — even as the chlórdécone contamination is permanent, the criminal accountability has, after twenty years, been denied, the banana monoculture endures, the sargassum returns, and a colonial and dependency dynamic runs through it all, and this guide has been honest about that from its first line. And yet the effort is far from futile — indeed real gains are genuinely won — because the chlórdécone legacy can be confronted through health recognition, decontamination science, the legal and EU channels, and the movement, because the land and food can be protected, because the sea and sargassum can be managed, because the coast can be defended, and because the law, the EU, the science, and the movement genuinely work; and those levers of the chlórdécone, the land, the sea, the coast, and the channels are real.

Some honest truths hold across every effort here. **Martinique is a rule-of-law territory with real courts, rights, science, and a powerful movement. The health harm is now recognised in part, a genuine if partial win. The contamination is permanent, and criminal justice has been denied. And a colonial**

dynamic runs through it all, to be reckoned with honestly. Hold both truths at once: real, effective levers of law, science, health recognition, and mass mobilisation, and the honest weight of a permanent poison, a denied accountability, and a colonial legacy.

Above all, keep the discipline that gives these efforts their force. Document the harm and the science. Confront the chlordécone legacy through health recognition, decontamination science, the legal and EU channels, and the movement. Protect the land and food through agroecology and food safety. Defend the sea and manage the sargassum. Protect the coast and heritage. Use the law, the EU, the science, and the movement. And reckon honestly with the colonial dynamic — because in a rule-of-law European territory confronting a permanent contamination and a colonial legacy, an effort that confronts the chlordécone legacy and defends health, land, and sea through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement is one that is both effective and just.

Martinique is a mountainous, volcanic Caribbean island of banana fields and rainforest beneath the towering Mount Pelée, a French and European land of real courts and rights whose soil, rivers, and sea carry a poison used for two decades after its dangers were known, whose people carry it in their blood, and whose long search for justice has met acknowledgment without full accountability. This guide has hidden none of that — the permanence of the contamination, the denial of the criminal case, the endurance of the monoculture, the return of the sargassum, the colonial dynamic that shadows it all — and there is no promise that the poison can be removed or that criminal justice will come. But this is a rule-of-law European territory, with strong science, real rights, EU and human-rights channels, a free press, and one of the most powerful civic movements in this series. Those are the levers, and they are real: the health recognition and compensation that have already begun; the food-safety protection that defends what people eat; the decontamination research that seeks to manage what cannot be removed; the legal, EU, and human-rights avenues that press accountability even after the criminal denial; and the mass movement that has put a mobilised people at the heart of the struggle. There are real limits — the permanent poison, the denied justice, the colonial dynamic — and this guide has named them throughout, and insisted on grounding everything in the strong science and reckoning honestly with the colonial legacy. But the poisoned land and waters and people of Martinique are worth every rigorous, persistent, science-grounded effort, the levers that run through the law, the EU, the science, and the movement are real and effective, and the work of confronting the chlordécone legacy, protecting health and food, and defending the land and sea — winning recognition, protection, and every measure of the justice long owed — is one that Martinicans, through their courts, their science, and their powerful movement, can genuinely do. So can you.